

**Goal:** to outline the MVP for Wedding Recon's Vendor Verification service, and relevant context, such that an AI agent can build the product, provide feedback/disagree, and make excellent design decision tradeoffs.

**Context:** Wedding Recon launched, in Colorado only, a few weeks ago. Feedback was overwhelmingly positive from couples & prospective brides, signaling a real gap in the space and yielding ~400 weekly active users. As a direct result, costs are climbing (database upgrades, Google Places queries, etc.), and this doesn't include ad spend likely needed to continue to grow the platform. In parallel, an unexpected emergent behavior surfaced: vendors reached out to me asking to add their business, or update their business's information, on the site to make their services more reachable. After speaking to venue owners, it appears that generating more traffic is, unsurprisingly, a top business goal.

**Thesis:** We can offer a paid vendor tier that will both a) provide value to vendors in their customer acquisition journey, and b) cover (& surpass) the costs of maintaining the site.

**What is it:** At a high level, Vendor Verification is a paid advertising tier on Wedding Recon that allows vendors to maximize information accuracy and visibility. Vendors can pay \$20/month, and in return, Verified Vendors receive:

- A "verified vendor" checkmark/UI to provide maximum credibility to site visitors
- Sorted to the top of the list feed throughout the product site for maximum visibility
- A portal to enter key information about their business (e.g. pricing, key details) and "introduce" themselves as a business
- A CTA link that will be shown to users (e.g. "Book a tour") to drive action

Note that I'm choosing to brand the offering as "Vendor Verification" rather than "Ads" so that the product feels more credible to site users and vendors.

### **Requirements:**

I'll include proposals/ideas/mockups for how to accomplish the user requirements below, but I'd consider those soft suggestions, not hard requirements. We should feel encouraged to propose better/alternative ideas that align with the high level product goals and the user requirements. We should also recognize that this is a low-revenue product at best, at least for the foreseeable future, and we should index heavily on simple and low-cost/free options when thinking about the tech stack.

### Account Creation

As a vendor, I want to sign up to verify my existing business, whether it is or is not on the site currently.

### *Suggestion(s)*

- Add a sign up/sign in flow, specifically for vendors/businesses, from the landing page
- Vendor email addresses can also be used as user email addresses
- When signing up for the first time, ask vendors to link their business to their account

- Follow a similar protocol as the “Add Recon” flow: if they can search & find their vendor, then link the existing business. If not, allow them to add a new business manually.

### Vendor Information

As a vendor, I want to add and edit key information about my vendor, including a CTA site visitors can reach me at.

#### *Suggestion(s):*

- After a vendor is signed in & linked to their business, provide a page to input the following information:
  - Pricing (an editable,  $n \times n$  table for complex pricing permutations)
  - All filter tags for their vendor type (e.g. venue = capacity, catering options, etc)
  - Website (optional)
  - Instagram (optional)
  - Photos (upload)
  - A CTA “name” and “link” (e.g. “Book a tour”, with a link to calendly)
- The information should be editable by the vendor user anytime, when logged in, with a “save” button

### Verification Features

As a site visitor, I want to see all of the information input by vendors.

#### *Suggestion(s)*

- Override filter tags, website, and instagram with information provided by the vendor, since we know it’s the most accurate/up to date.
- Include the exact pricing table, and the vendor introductory text, as a header at the top of the vendor details page. Include the CTA here as well.

As a site visitor, I want to know if a vendor has verified their business.

- All verified vendors should have a green checkmark/border throughout the site (e.g. vendor preview cards, planning hub, list view, etc) with sub-text “verified vendor”

As a site visitor, I want to see trusted vendors first.

- In any list view, verified vendors should sort first in their matching category. We should NOT move them outside of their partition. For example: if a vendor is truly a filter match, they should be listed first. If they’re not a filter match, they should list first in the “Other partial matches” partition.

### Billing

As the site founder, I want to make it trivial for vendors to sign up for the \$20/month verification tier.

#### *Suggestion(s)*

- When a vendor clicks “save” on their vendor information, we should check to see if there is valid billing on file. If not, we should prompt them to enter their information to kick off their subscription and save their information.

As the site founder, I want to require a 6 month minimum for vendor verification upon sign up.

As the site founder, I want to be in standard compliance with billing best practices: cancelling subscriptions, notifications of monthly payment, etc.

As the site founder, we should only provide the verified perks while the vendor is a paying customer

- If a customer cancels their subscription, we should remove all vendor-verified UI/perks, including the filter tag override.

### Reporting

As the site founder, I want to know how my subscription business is going.

### *Suggestion(s):*

- Track basic information like clicks on the vendor verification button, vendor accounts created, subscriptions completed, etc.

### **Rollout Plan:**

- 1) Reach out to Christina, Christina’s referrals, and other vendors who have reached out via email/facebook/Reddit.
- 2) Find ~100 Colorado vendor email addresses (~30 non-corporate venues) and send an email blast with options to a) sign up, or b) jump on a call.